

Kevin Bryson

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EDUCATION

University of Chicago, Chicago, Illinois, USA

- Ph.D. Candidate in Computer Science 2021 – Present
 - Advisor: Blase Ur
 - Thesis: My research identifies systemic gaps in the production of algorithmic systems where organizational priorities undermine fairness, usability, and transparency goals.

Morehouse College, Atlanta, Georgia, USA

- B.S. in Computer Science, minor in Mathematics 2017 – 2021
 - Graduated Summa Cum Laude
 - Cumulative GPA: 3.86 / 4.00

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS * INDICATES FIRST AUTHORSHIP

***Auditing the Personalization of Search Results on TikTok** In progress

- Collected user data requests from TikTok through a user study
- Compiled video metadata and search results from the TikTok API
- Calculated the personalization in the main feed resulting from making certain types of searches

***Characterizing Data Scientists' Perceptions of Data Modification** In submission

- Conducted a user study of perceptions of a set of methods which modify data to achieve fairness goals
- Found that tensions with modifying data stems from adherence to normative data science practices
- Constructed recommendations for the fairness community to reevaluate norms and values which are barriers to fairness

***Characterizing the Usability and Usefulness of Ad Transparency Systems** [IEEE S&P26](#)

- Qualitatively analyzed the features and characteristics of ad transparency systems on 22 platforms
- Conducted a user study in which we found that the systems lack functionality users desire and are simultaneously complex and lacking key details

Contextual Notifications That Highlight Fairness Issues for Data Scientists [CHI 24](#)

- Developed features for a JupyterLab extension which would contextually reveal fairness disparities between demographics through notifications
- The user study demonstrated that the notifications successfully nudged participants to account for missing data, minimize demographic differences in model performance, and exhibit healthy skepticism about their models

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Mansueto Institute for Urban Innovation - UChicago, Data Journalist Fellow 2024 – 2025

- Created novel procedures to link housing and LLC records which revealed obfuscated networks of property ownership
- Collaborated with journalists and editors at WBEZ Chicago and Injustice Watch

Physical Sciences Division - UChicago, Journalist Intern 2022 – 2023

- Interviewed and wrote about researchers and their work within UChicago's PSD

Lyte, Data Scientist Intern 2021

- Developed a machine learning pipeline for customer segmentation

TEACHING, MENTORING, & SERVICE

Data4All, UChicago, Invited Speaker 2022– 2024

Data Liberation Project, Volunteer 2024

“Critical Data Science: Data Storytelling and Justice”, Morehouse, Instructor & Curriculum 2022

INTERESTS

Film photography, biking and baking.